UNIT-2

CONSONANTS

Description of Consonants

- Consonants sounds can be characterized according to three main phonetic properties:
- **Place of articulation** : which refers to where in the mouth the sound is produced.
- **Manner of Articulation**: which refers to the way the air is obstructed in the mouth while producing the sound.
- **Voicing:** which refers to whether or not there is a vibration of the vocal cords as the sound is produced.

a) Place of Articulation

i) Bilabial sounds

ii) Labio- dental sounds

iii) Dental

iv) Alveolar

v) Post- Alveolar

vi) Palato- Alveolar

vii) Palatal

viii) Velar

ix) Glottal

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Consonants-Places of Articulation

Bilabial	p	b
Labio-dental	f	v
Inter-dental	ð	θ
Alveolar	t	d
Palato-Alveolar	dʒ	ʧ
Palatal	j	
Velar	k	g
Glottal	h	

Place of Articulation:

- **i)Bilabial sounds**:- Two lips are the articulators. The initial sounds in English words,
- **eg- /p/, /b/,and /m/** as in pin, bin, mile
- **ii)Labio- dental sounds**:- The active articulator is the lower lip and the passive articulators are the upper front teeth. **eg- /f/ and /v/** as in fine , vine
- **iii)Dental:**- The tip of the tongue is the active articulator and the upper front teeth are the passive articulators. The initial words in the English words-**/θ/and /ð/as** in thin and then.

Place of Articulation

iv) Alveolar:- The tip or the blade of the tongue is the active articulator and the teeth ridge is the passive articulator. The initial sounds in the English **words / t/, /d/, /n/,/s/, /z/,/l/** as in tin, din, near, sin, zip, & live.

V)Post- Alveolar:-The tip of the tongue is the active articulator and the part of the roof of the mouth that lies immediately behind the teeth ridge is the passive articulator. The sound represented by the letters **/r/** as in try & dry.

Vi)Palato- Alveolar:- The tip of the tongue and blade of the tongue are the active articulators and the teeth ridge is the passive articulator. Simultaneously , the front of the tongue is raised in the direction of the hard palate. The initial sounds in the English words-**/tʃ/ & /dʒ/** as in cheap, chin, jump, jeep.

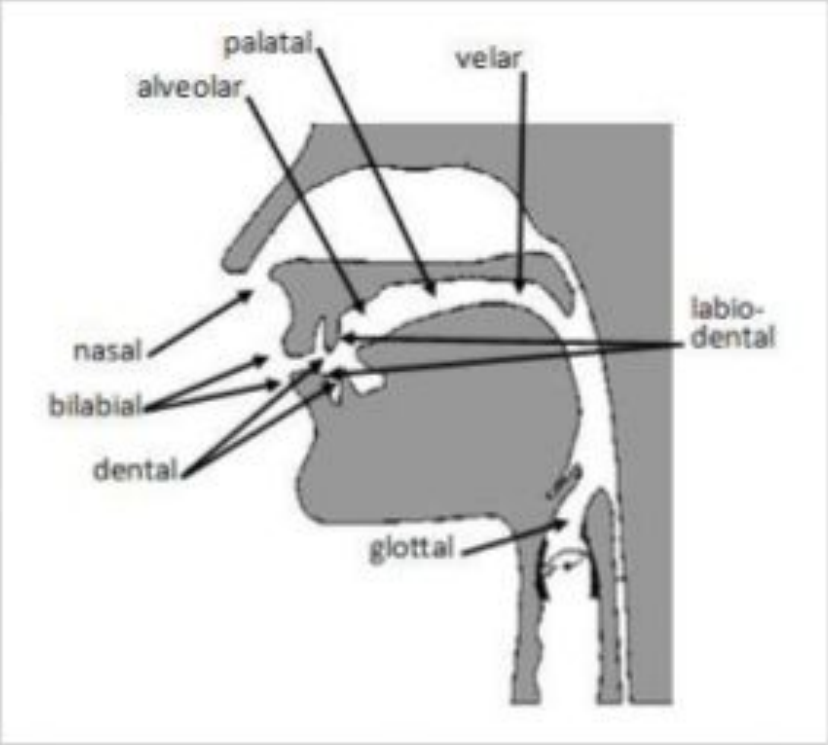
Place of Articulation

vii)Palatal:-The front of the tongue is the active articulator and the hard palate is the passive articulator. The initial sound in the English word- **/j/** as in yes & young.

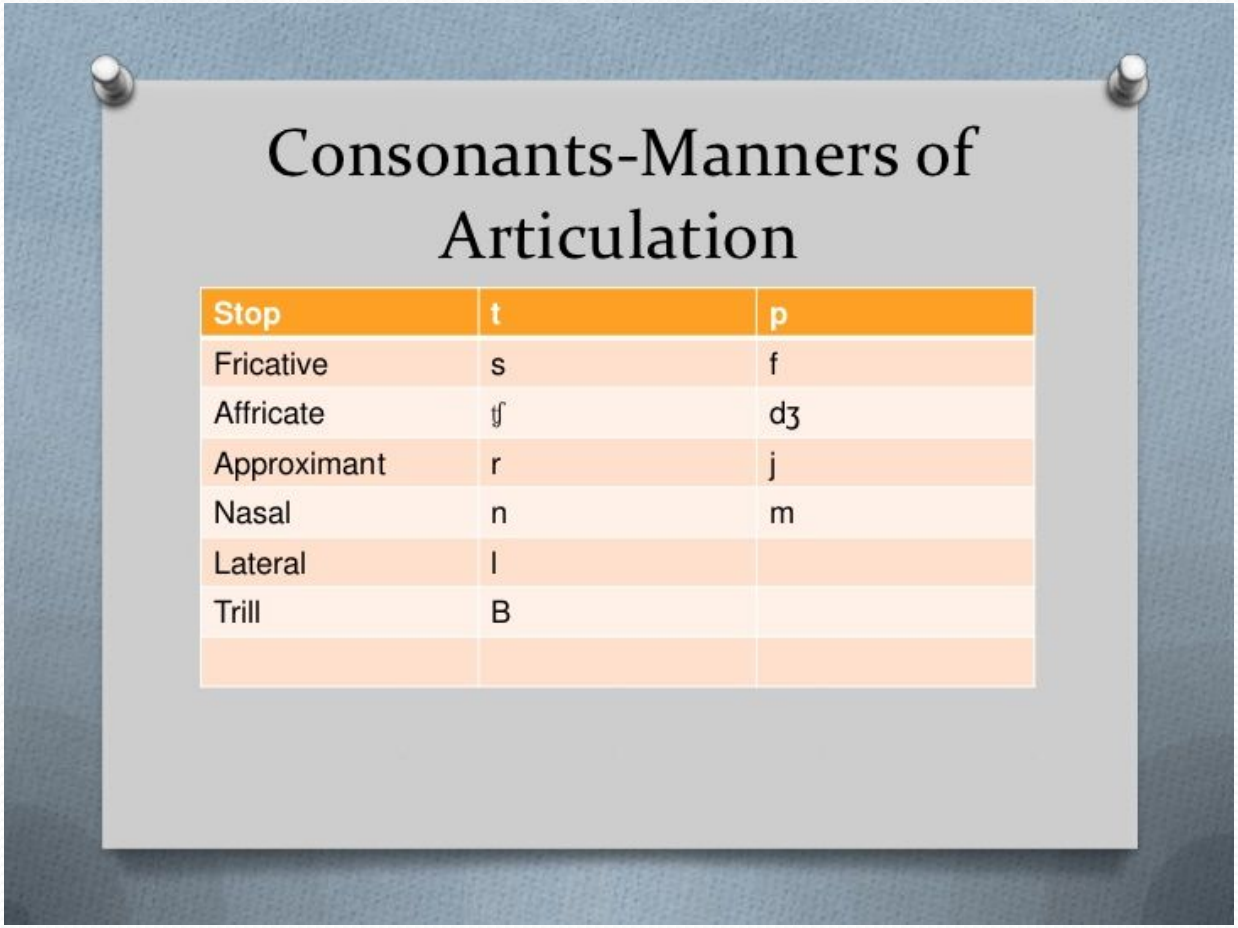
viii)Velar:- The back of the tongue is the active articulator and the soft palate is the passive articulator. The first sounds in the English words- **/g/** as in bag, bang, king.

ix)Glottal:- Glottal Sounds are produced at the glottis and the two vocal cords are the articulators. The initial sound in the English words - **/h/** as in hat , him .

Places of Articulation



2. Manner of Articulation



Consonants-Manners of Articulation

Stop	t	p
Fricative	s	f
Affricate	ʧ	dʒ
Approximant	r	j
Nasal	n	m
Lateral	l	
Trill	B	

b)Manner of Articulation

- Speech sound are differentiated by the way airstream is affected as it travels from the lungs up and out of the mouth and nose.
- This is referred to as the manner of articulation for the sound.

i)Stops or Plosives:- such sounds are produced by a complete obstruction of the airstream in the mouth, **eg- /p/, /b/, /t/, /k/, & /g/ as in pin, bin, tin, din, kite, gun.**

ii)Fricatives:- such sounds are produced by a partial obstruction of the airstream , where the passage in the mouth through which the air escapes is very narrow, causing friction,

eg- /f/, /v/, /s/, /z/, /d/, /ʃ/, as in fun, vine, sin, zoom, tin, dream, shrink & zoom

Manner of Articulation

iii)Affricates:-such sounds are produced by a stop closure followed immediately by a slow release of the closure characteristic of the fricative, eg-**/tʃ/&/dʒ/** as in chin, cheat, jump, jar.

iv)Approximants:- such sounds are produced with little or no obstruction of the air in the mouth, eg- **/j/ & /w**/. When occurring in a word they must always be either followed or preceded by a vowel, and in their articulation the tongue moves rapidly in a gliding fashion either toward or away from a neighboring vowel. As in yet, young, watch, warm.

v)Lateral:- such sound is produced when the air flows over the sides of the tongue.

- Eg- **/l/** -as in live, learn, long.

Classification of NAE Consonant Phonemes

Manner of Articulation	Place of Articulation						
	Bilabial	Labiodental	Dental	Alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Glottal
Stop Voiceless Voiced	p b			t d		k g	
Fricative Voiceless Voiced		f v	θ ð	s z	ʃ ʒ		h
Affricate Voiceless Voiced					tʃ dʒ		
Nasal Voiced	m			n		ŋ	
Liquid Voiced				l	r		
Glide Voiced	w				y		

c).Voicing:-

- **Voicing**:-which refers to whether or not there is a vibration of the vocal cords as the sound is produced.
- **Voiced Consonants**: These are the consonants which are produced from the larynx and the pronunciation of the same will make the vocal cord vibrate.eg- /**z**/ in zip, zoom,
- **Voiceless consonants**:- These are the consonant sounds which are produced from the tip of the tongue and there will be no vibration of vocal chord while pronouncing the same
- As in /**s**/- sin, some, sell, .
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Questions?

- Q1. Explain the Nasal sounds with examples.
- /n/, /m/, n(ing)-no, noise,none, man, moon,many, ring, going
- Q2. Explain the Bilabial sounds with examples.
- Q3. Explain the Velar sounds with examples.
- Q4. Draw a neat diagram of voiced and voiceless position of vocal cords.